

WHAT IS hope?



WHERE WE GO FROM HERE

Closing Out Ten Years, Looking Ahead Together

As we close out this Tenth Anniversary, we stand grounded in gratitude and unwavering in our commitment to justice. This year affirmed how powerfully The Hive is woven into the lives, leadership, and lived experiences of the survivors and communities who guide our work. It reminded us that our purpose is not abstract—it is lived daily in the stories we hold, the barriers we confront, and the healing we witness.

“ Ten years in, The Hive remains rooted in the voices and lived experiences of the survivors and communities who guide our work.

Looking ahead, our work will continue to evolve in ways that reflect the emerging needs and cultural realities of those we serve. We know that healing and safety require more than crisis response—they require systems change, community collaboration, collective power building, sustained advocacy, and long-term pathways toward stability, wellness, and economic security. Our economic justice work has always reached beyond immediate crisis relief. It is about confronting the structural conditions that shape survivors' financial realities and creating opportunities for autonomy, stability, and long-term possibility.

We will continue to strengthen our services, deepen our technical assistance, and create spaces where survivors and community members can build collective power. And while we do not over-define what the next chapter will look like, we remain committed to listening deeply, responding with integrity, and honoring the wisdom of those most impacted.

“ We move into our next decade grounded in gratitude, guided by community wisdom, and unwavering in our commitment to justice.



MESSAGE FROM OUR FOUNDER & CEO

While 2025 brought a year marked by uncertainty, change, and significant challenges, it also revealed the depth of our collective strength and the unwavering power of community rooted in care.

Because of you, our partners, donors, volunteers, and advocates, we did more than close a historic funding gap. We stood firm in the face of uncertainty and began reshaping The Hive with renewed purpose, more profound clarity, and unwavering alignment with our mission. What began as my personal commitment to create a safer, more compassionate, and more just community has grown into a collective movement—one upheld by people who believe in freedom, dignity, and the transformative power of community care.

Over the past ten years, The Hive has carried the brilliance, resilience, and stories of survivors—particularly Black and Brown women and girls who deserve healing on their own terms. Even when the work has been heavy, you have helped us hold the weight. You have stood with us, poured into us, and affirmed that this work matters.

As we step into a new year and the dawn of our next decade, I invite you to remain in community with us: stay close, support in the ways you can, speak truth where you are, and continue helping us build a future where survivors are not only safe, but fully seen, deeply supported, and boldly thriving.

With determination, gratitude, and unwavering faith,

Ashley T. Olayinka

Founder & CEO, The Hive Community Circle



A DECADE OF TRANSFORMATION

Ten years ago, The Hive Community Circle was established with an urgent mission: to help prevent violence against some of the most vulnerable populations in our community. Since our founding, we have provided direct services to more than 3,000 primary and secondary survivors of intimate partner violence, sexual assault, and stalking, and reached nearly 4,000 community members through prevention, education, and outreach.

Through individual and group counseling, crisis management, safety planning, legal advocacy, bilingual advocacy, and emergency economic relief, we reduce the barriers to mental health care, economic mobility, and wellness services that survivors often face.

In 2025, we expanded our services to include children under 11 whose parents are also receiving services from The Hive, ensuring early intervention and whole family healing. Additionally, we launched a partnership with Benedict College, providing technical assistance for the implementation of culturally specific services, outreach, and prevention. We are elated to share that as a result of over 20 local businesses under the guidance and leadership of Samantha and Carlos Diaz owners of We Love Construction, The Hive will be opening our very own Survivor's Pantry Boutique space what once a she shed donated by Stanley Martin on behalf of our former Board Chair Michael Lewis, will now be a uniquely and intentionally curated space for survivors and members of the community to access essential household items to additionally meet their culturally specific needs as well. We believe all who find themselves in a position of need are worthy of accessing resources with dignity, care, and that honor their humanity.

FOR EVERY CALL WE ANSWER, HOPE GROWS.

We continue to see a demand for the services organizations like ours provide, even as funding cuts impact victim service programs across our community. This past year has brought challenges to our work, but the need and our mission remain urgent and critical to fulfill.



FACING FACTS IN SC*

3,536

survivors of sexual assault who sought services from a rape crisis center

35

women, and 11 men, were murdered by a household member

6

highest domestic violence rates in the United States

89%

of reported sexual assaults were female with 47% under the age of 18

92%

of survivors who sought services statewide knew their offender

24

counties reported one or more domestic homicides in 2024 (up from 15 in 2023)

***SOURCES:**

World Population Review (2025)

CDC, The National Intimate Partner and Sexual Violence Survey (NISVS)

South Carolina Domestic Violence Fatality Report (2024)

South Carolina Coalition Against Domestic Violence and Sexual Assault (2024)

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Six months ago, The Hive changed my life in ways I never imagined possible. After surviving a painful domestic violence situation, I was left feeling broken, lost, and unsure of what my future held. But the moment I was introduced to their program, I was met with compassion, understanding, and unwavering support. The Hive didn't just offer me resources—they offered me hope.

Ajaliyah

Former Program Participant



HOW HOPE GROWS

THE HIVE'S 2024–25 IMPACT

\$288,688

invested in survivors
within South
Carolina

152

survivors overall served
by The Hive's
peer support services

177

emergency and
economic relief
services fulfilled

50

survivors who
received
counseling

528

community members
impacted by outreach
programming

\$27,003

invested in mental
health services for
survivors

\$48,663

invested in prevention
and outreach

107

community members
attended Hive trainings

2024-2025 REVENUE

\$819,067.45

Foundations: \$44,580.30

Contributions: \$774,279.69*

Earned Income: \$207.46

**including \$643,389.56 in government grants*





Our impact was made possible thanks to our volunteers, team members, board of directors, donors, and funding partners: Amalgamated Charitable Fund, The Office of Violence Against Women, SC Attorney General's Office, Honey Bee Fund, Junior League of Columbia, United Way of the Midlands, SC Sisters of Charity Foundation, Central Carolina Community Foundation, Cypress Fund, The Emergent Fund, The Milliken Family and Ananda Fund, and Lexington Medical Center.

Your commitment to our mission enables The Hive to support and empower survivors throughout their healing journey.

WHAT IS
hope?

YOU ARE.

#BeeHopeNow



THE
hive

COMMUNITY CIRCLE

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